



Mad about ads: (L to R) Vishwajit Das, Deepak Cheda and Laxmikanth Kulkarni

contacts as well as ad rates is rather useful, especially for media organisations. With constant tinkering, the customised applications are particularly effective.”

One of Mediaware’s recent clients, Parle Products, was looking for a solution to curb escalating media budgets. They also wanted to track and monitor media activity, and expenses related to advertising and retrieval problems.

Mediaware, which has taken up this project, will design an Oracle-based database solution for Parle on a .NET platform. Their solution will help Parle eliminate paper from the entire process, by receiving and sending reports from Parle’s media agencies in the form of e-documents, receiving telecast certificates online, in electronic format, automatic bill passing and transferring purchase vouchers and credit notes online, among other things.

The solution will also aid Parle integrate their media agency’s (Rediffusion/TME) software with their new software system to receive estimates electronically from the latter—in a secure manner.

Parle officials say, “Until now, we didn’t have a process in place. With this solution, the workflow will be smooth and work will be allotted in a better manner.”

Life Insurance Corporation (LIC) is another big organisation that found the need for Mediaware’s solutions. Venkateshwaran, Executive (Publicity) for LIC (Mumbai) says, “We purchased the AMW software (software + database solution) to automatically prepare estimates and budget details. I find it a rather useful tool. We have been using this software for several years now.”

On To Convergence

Mediaware’s Kulkarni affirms, “I think we succeeded because we have domain knowledge built over time and our clients prefer that. By utilising an existing network like the Internet, we were able to provide a boost to our database and workflow-related services—especially for prompt delivery of updates.”

Mediaware plans to expand their target market to advertisers as well, in addition to ad-agencies and media houses.

The trio foresees a healthy future for advertising. “Although agencies are not really cutting down on budgets, they want to find innovative ways to catch the customer’s eye. They now offer more promotional schemes and bargains,” says Das.

Convergence is another trend to watch out for. Das opines, “Internet advertising is on the rise. But it is only about one per cent of the ad spend in India. However, I think convergence is closer than we think. A combination of Internet plus TV will provide advertisers more reach than ever.”

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